

Right on the Money

STATE BANK OF INDIA (SBI) seems to have hit a purple patch since **Dinesh Kumar Khara** joined the country's largest lender as its Chairman on October 7, 2020. The SBI stock has gained more than 200 per cent since then. Recently, the bank also posted its highest ever quarterly net profit (consolidated) of ₹14,752 crore in Q2FY23. For SBI, Khara seems to be the man with the Midas touch.

—PRINCE TYAGI



'SNAP'PED

Ajit Mohan, who was VP & MD of Facebook India (Meta), has quit the firm to join rival photo-sharing app Snapchat as its Asia-Pacific President. With short videos becoming the battleground for social media platforms, it will be interesting to see how Mohan, who came to Meta from Hotstar, will leverage the India market for the Evan Spiegel-founded company, which saw its net loss surge to \$360 million as of September. India accounts for 144 million daily active users (DAU) out of Snapchat's 363 million DAUs worldwide.

—VIDYA S.

Hit & Miss

Falguni Nayar-led Nykaa's parent FSN E-Commerce Ventures issued bonus shares (1:5) on November 10, a day before the lock-in for its pre-IPO shareholders expired. While some termed it a masterstroke, others called it short-sighted. As feared, Nykaa's stock crashed by 10 per cent after the bonus shares were credited to demat accounts.

—SOHINI MITTER



A FRIEND IN NEED

During his recent two-day trip to Moscow, Foreign Minister **S. Jaishankar** said that oil purchases from Russia were benefiting India. He said that India was committed to maintaining a strong and steady relationship with its time-tested partner Russia. "We have seen that the India-Russia relationship has worked to our advantage. So, if that works to our advantage, I would like to keep that going," he said.

—MANISH PANT



CHANGING LANES

Toyota Kirloskar Motor is looking to phase out Urban Cruiser, the rebadged version of Maruti Suzuki's Brezza, in favour of newer models. Vice Chairman **Vikram Kirloskar** said the company will focus on the changing market dynamics with its new offering in the compact SUV segment, the Urban Cruiser Hyryder. Toyota has invested about ₹4,800 crore on developing the SUV, which according to him, is seeing heightened interest.

—PRERNA LIDHOO



VOCAL FOR LOCAL



RIDHAM DESAI, MD of Morgan Stanley India, believes that investors should look at "businesses that are focussed on India than overseas" as those will benefit from the growth rates. "The quintessential sector for everyone to buy is financial services as Indians and Indian companies are going to borrow money," Desai said, while picking consumption and financial services as his two main bets.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

Delivering Good Growth



DEEPIINDER GOYAL, Founder & CEO of food delivery firm Zomato, says the firm is moving towards profitability and "has room for much faster growth". It's also reportedly planning to lay off 4 per cent of its workforce. In Q2FY23, it narrowed consolidated losses by 42.3 per cent YoY, while consolidated revenues surged 62.20 per cent, and total adjusted revenue grew 48 per cent YoY to ₹2,107 crore, which translates to annualised revenue of \$1.05 billion—the first quarter when it has happened. But following its stock's dismal performance, Goyal is keeping a sharp eye on the bottom line.

—BINU PAUL

AJIT MOHAN PHOTO BY RAJWANT RAWAT; FALGUNI NAYAR PHOTO BY YASIR IQBAL; S. JAISHANKAR PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH